

THE JUDICIAL BRANCH

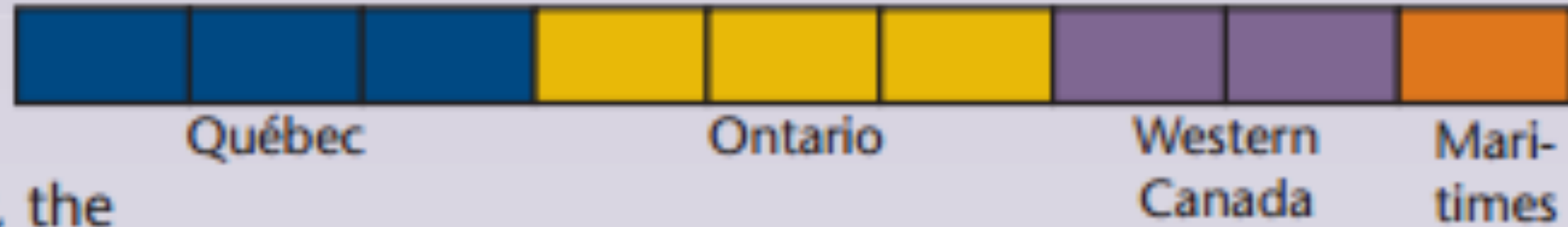
The Judicial Branch is the part of the government that interprets laws and applies the law by making legal judgments. **The Supreme Court of Canada is the highest level of court in Canada** which also makes it the highest level of the Judicial Branch. Those who work in the Judicial Branch must be trained in the law profession. The Judicial branch is not connected to the executive or legislative branch so that the judicial branch is not influenced by the other two. The main job of the judicial branch is to protect Canadians rights and freedoms. They deal with issues regarding intolerance, equality, discrimination, the criminal process and social questions. They have an odd number of judges, nine, so that they don't come to a stalemate in regards to a decision.



JUDICIAL BREAKDOWN

WHO BECOMES A SUPREME COURT JUDGE?

The Supreme Court has nine judges from four regions of Canada.



For most of Canada's history, the PM and cabinet have appointed Supreme Court judges when positions became vacant — when a judge retired, for example.

In February 2006, Prime Minister Stephen Harper changed the appointment process. The PM and cabinet now nominate judges, who then go through a review by a committee of MPs. In 2007, the PM still had the power to appoint the judge of his choice.



Check for an update on appointing Supreme Court judges. What's the procedure today?



This photo shows the judges of the Supreme Court in 2005. The court always has an uneven number of judges to prevent tie decisions.